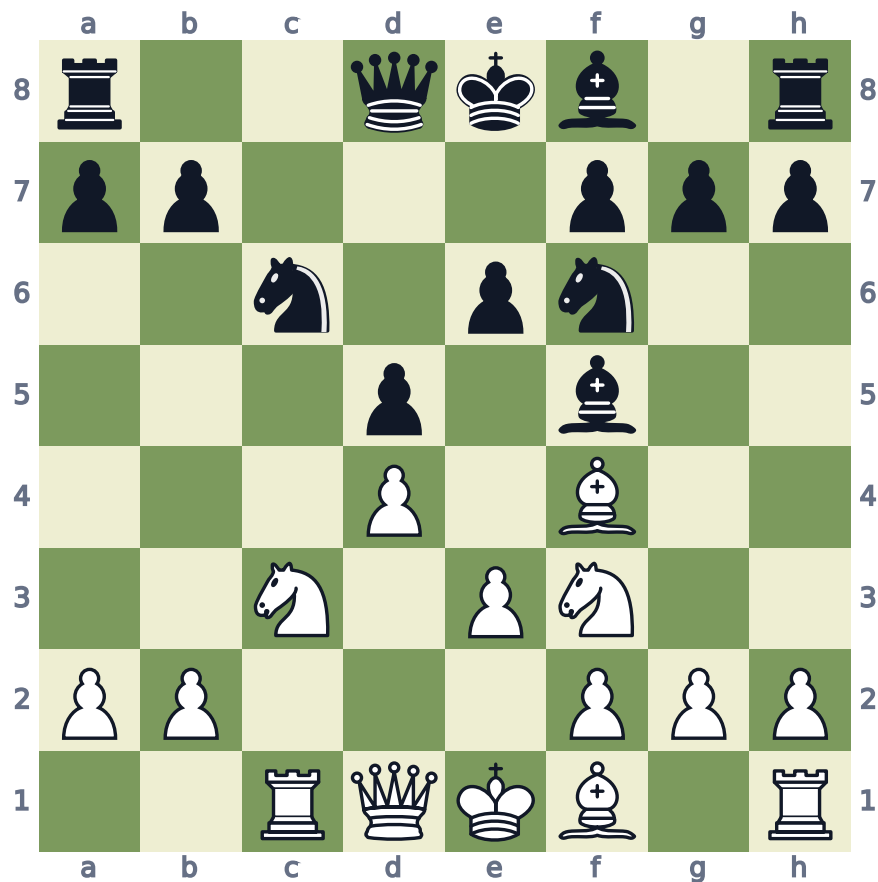


Slav and Semi-Slav Repertoire

Exchange Slav clarity, main-line recovery, Meran structures, and Triangle move orders



Handle ...c6 systems through structure recognition, efficient pawn recovery, and precise central timing.

8 learning units | diagrams | recall tests | engine-checked analysis

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Handle ...c6 systems through structure recognition, efficient pawn recovery, and precise central timing.

THE TRAINING LOOP

- First identify Black's defense from pawn placement and move order.
- At every diagram, name the center, the urgent threat, and two candidate moves.
- Hide the recall answer until you have spoken the move and its purpose.
- Replay each line from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected White repertoire. It covers the main structural and move-order decisions you need for practical play; the PGN companion makes later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

The Exchange Slav reduces Black's central asymmetry but not the need for active play.

PRINCIPLE 2

In the main Slav, a4 limits ...b5 and helps recover c4.

PRINCIPLE 3

The Semi-Slav shell is solid because ...e6 and ...c6 support d5, but it can become cramped.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Meran positions revolve around ...c5 and e4-e5.

PRINCIPLE 5

The Triangle can transpose or enter the Noteboom after ...dxc4.

PRINCIPLE 6

Do not memorize sharp pawn grabs without tracking development tempi.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

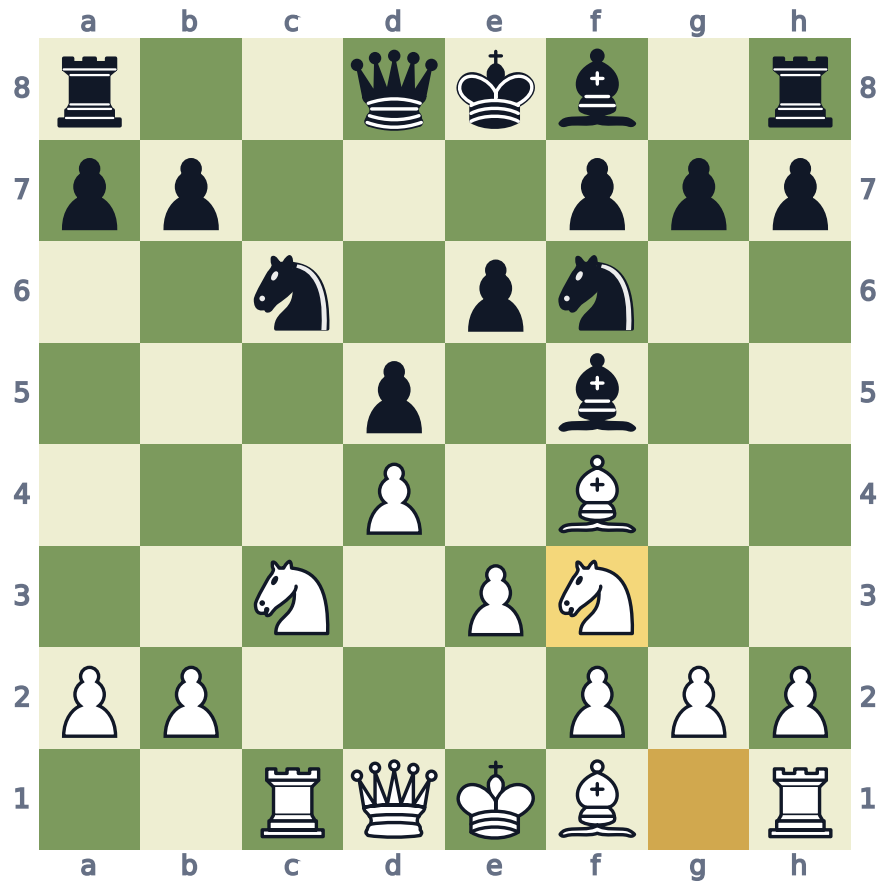
- | | | |
|-----------|-------------------------------|---|
| 01 | Exchange Slav | Bf4, Rc1, and Nf3 create useful pressure without structural risk. |
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| 02 | Main Slav recovery | a4 is the key anti-expansion move after ...dxc4. |
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| 03 | Slav ...a6 | Against ...a6 and ...b5, attack the chain's base and watch b4. |
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 | | |
| 04 | Slav ...g6 | A Slav fianchetto delays ...Bf5 but pressures d4 from afar. |
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 | | |
| 05 | Semi-Slav Meran | After ...b5, e4-e5 is the thematic counter in the center. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Anti-Meran with b3 | b3 prepares Bb2 and recaptures on c4 without queen moves. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Triangle move order | ...e6 plus ...c6 before ...Nf6 allows ...dxc4 and ...b5. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Semi-Slav quiet center | In a closed shell, both sides are preparing one freeing pawn break. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Exchange Slav



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. cxd5 cxd5 4. Nc3 Nf6 5. Bf4 Nc6 6. e3 Bf5 7. Rc1 e6 8. Nf3

WHITE'S IDEA

Use active piece placement and pressure the c-file in a symmetrical structure.

MAIN DANGER

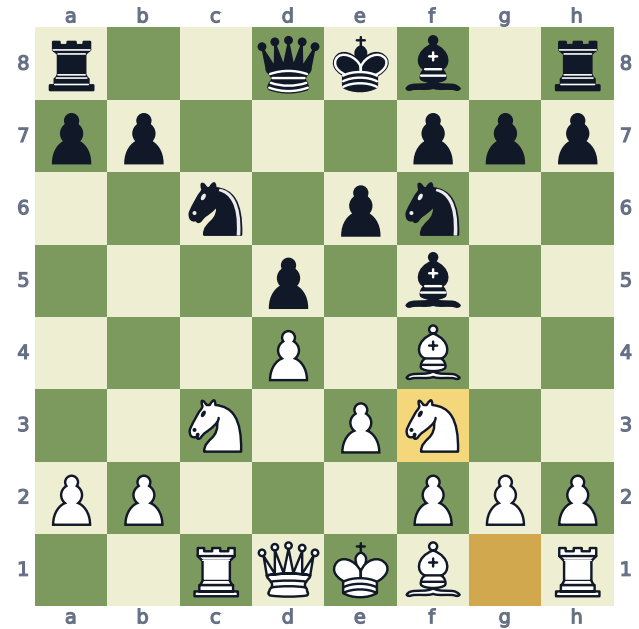
Symmetry does not mean a draw; careless development can still concede initiative.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Bf4, Rc1, and Nf3 create useful pressure without structural risk.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.21 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bb4 Bb5 2. Ne4 O-O 3. Bxc3 Bxc6+ 4. bxc6 bxc3 5. g5 Bg3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Exchange Slav



YOUR TASK

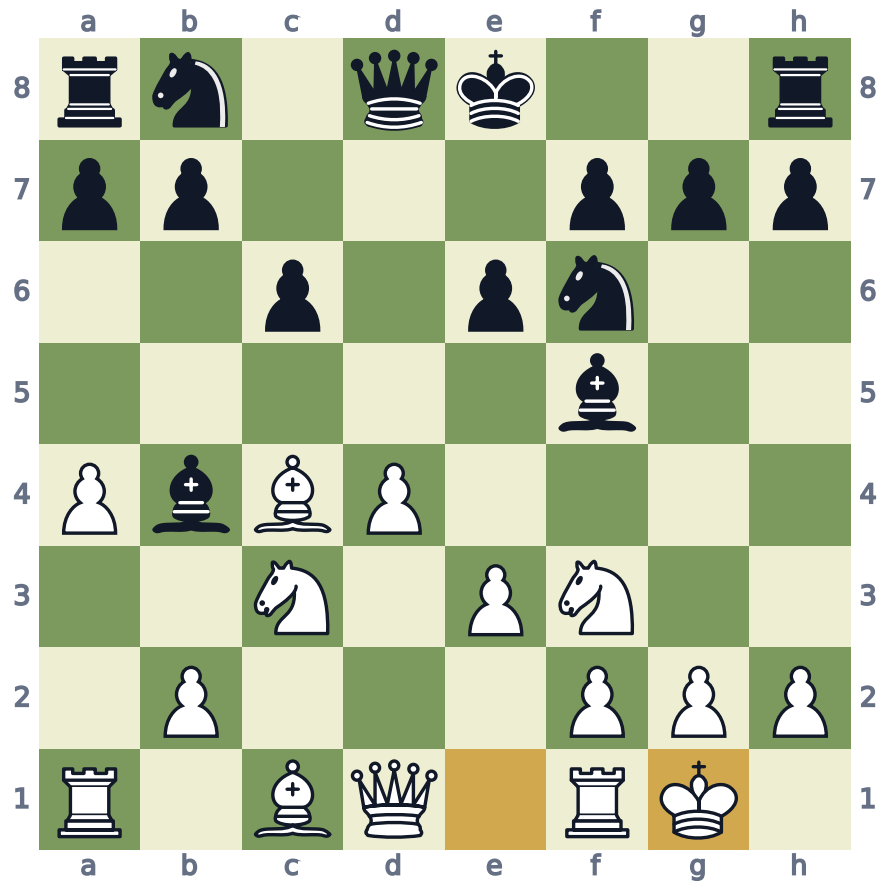
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Main Slav recovery



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 dxc4 5. a4 Bf5 6. e3 e6 7. Bxc4 Bb4 8. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

Limit ...b5, recover c4, and castle before central expansion.

MAIN DANGER

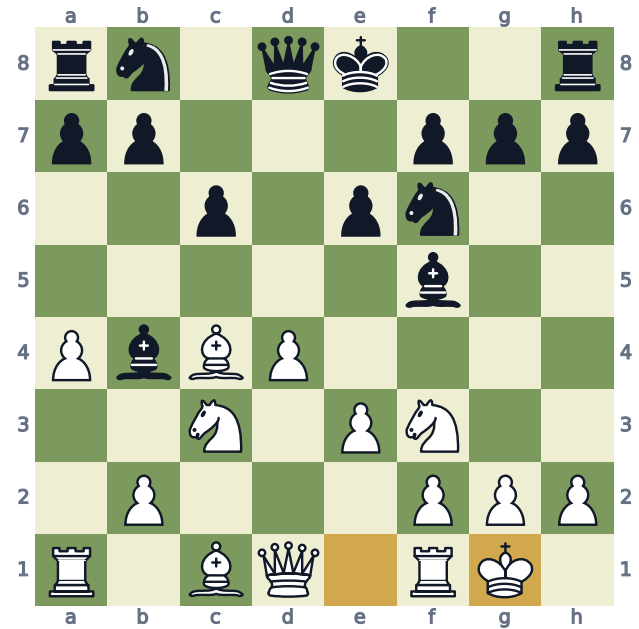
e4 can be met by ...b5 or ...Bb4 if played too early.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

a4 is the key anti-expansion move after ...dxc4.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.33 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. O-O Nh4 2. Nbd7 f3 3. Bg6 Qe2 4. c5 Nxg6 5. hxc6 Rd1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Main Slav recovery



YOUR TASK

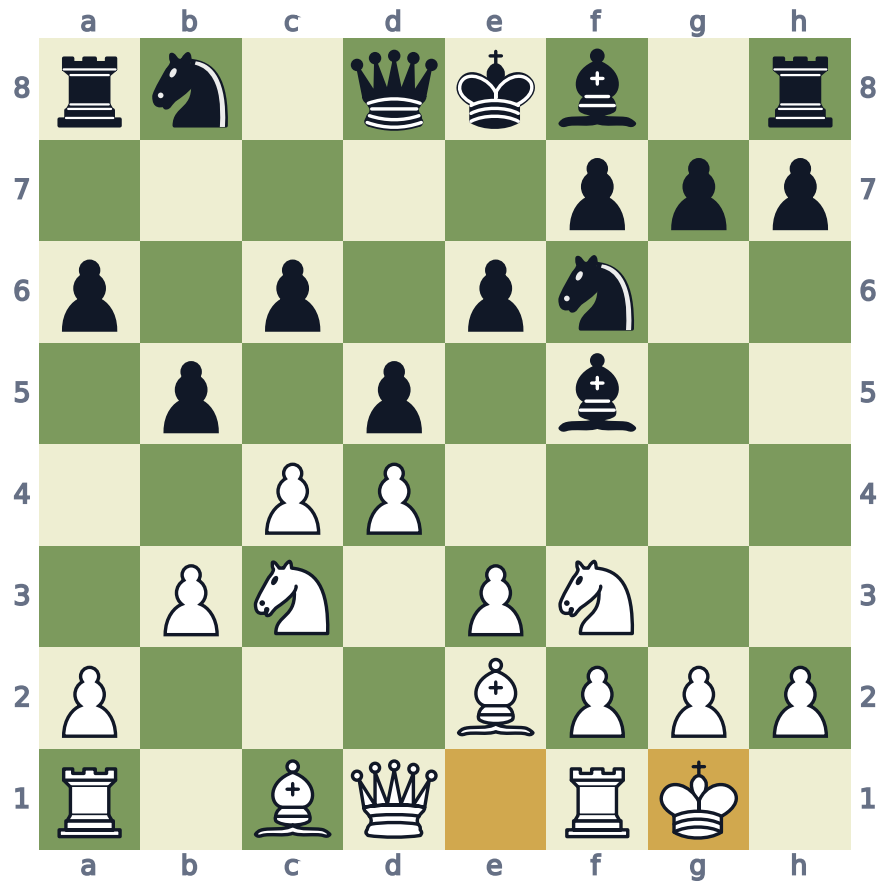
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Slav ...a6



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 a6 5. e3 b5 6. b3 Bf5 7. Be2 e6 8. O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

Challenge the queenside chain with b3 and complete development.

MAIN DANGER

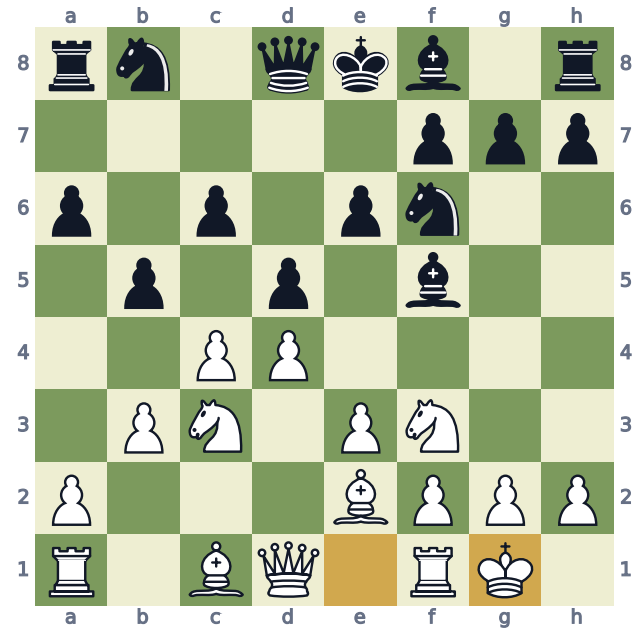
An automatic a4 can give Black a protected b4 square.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against ...a6 and ...b5, attack the chain's base and watch b4.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.30 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bd6 Nh4 2. O-O c5 3. Bc7 Nxf5 4. exf5 a4 5. b4 Na2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Slav ...a6



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Slav ...g6



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. Nc3 g6 5. Bf4 Bg7 6. e3 O-O 7. Be2

WHITE'S IDEA

Develop actively and prepare cxd5 or h3 according to Black's center.

MAIN DANGER

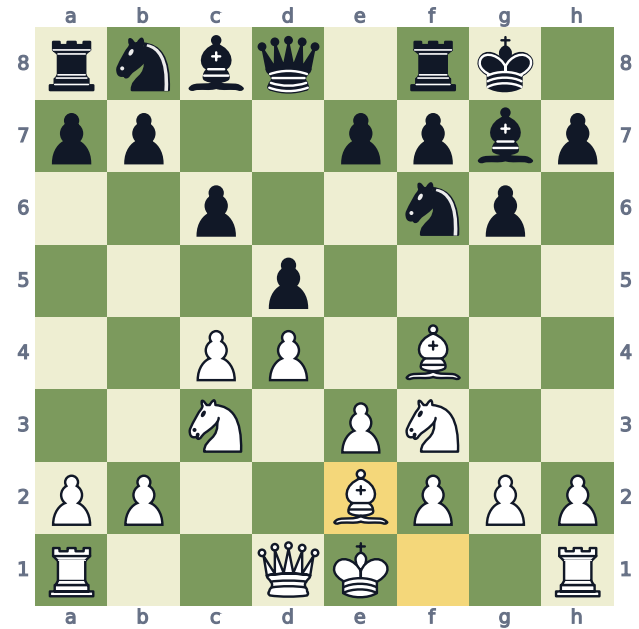
The g7 bishop gains force if White opens d4 carelessly.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A Slav fianchetto delays ...Bf5 but pressures d4 from afar.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.38 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. dxc4 Bxc4 2. c5 dxc5 3. Qa5 Rc1 4. Qxc5 Qb3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Slav ...g6



YOUR TASK

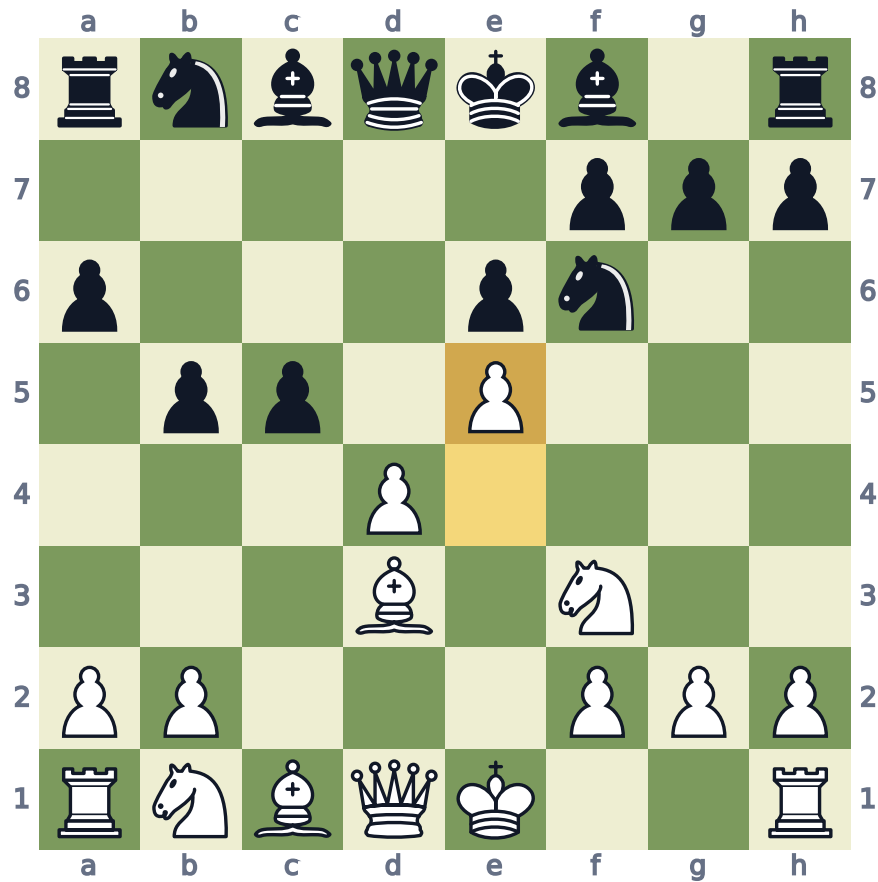
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Semi-Slav Meran



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bd3 dxc4 6. Bxc4 b5 7. Bd3 a6 8. e4 c5 9. e5

WHITE'S IDEA

Use the central pawn mass before Black completes queenside consolidation.

MAIN DANGER

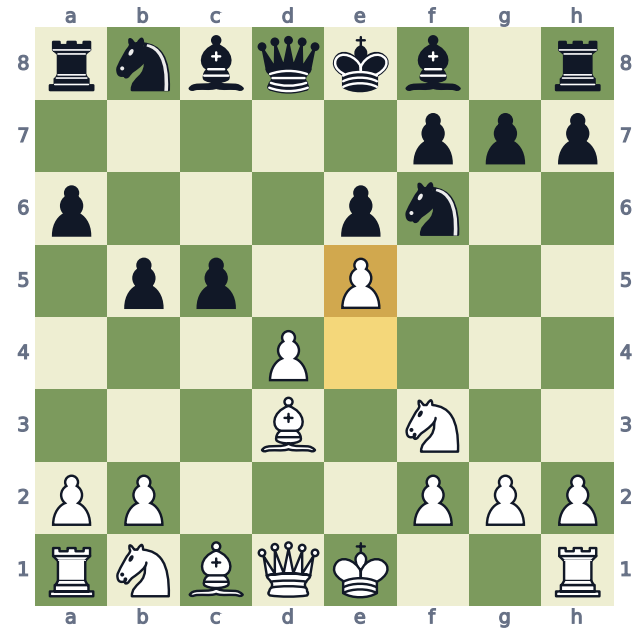
The center can be undermined by ...cxd4 and ...c5 tactics.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 8 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

After ...b5, e4-e5 is the thematic counter in the center.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

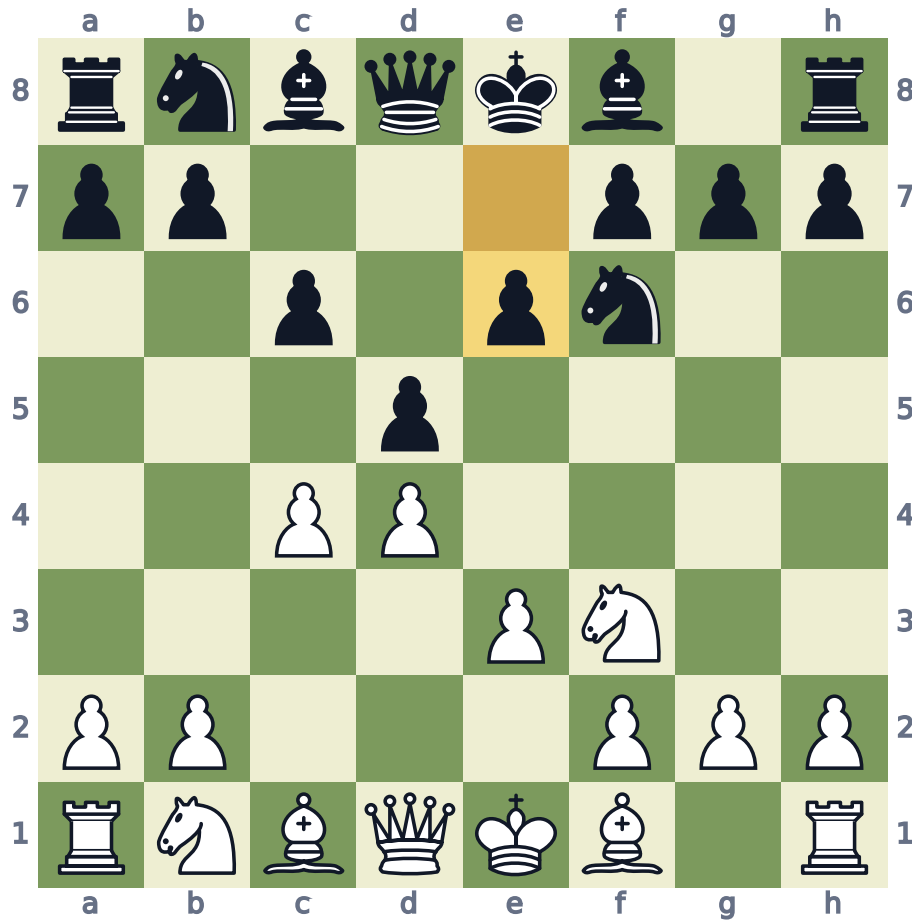
Position estimate: -0.12 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. Nd5 O-O 2. c4 Bc2 3. Be7 a3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Semi-Slav Meran



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Anti-Meran with b3



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. b3 Bb4+ 6. Bd2 Bd6 7. Bd3 O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

Recover c4 with b3 and keep a flexible piece setup.

MAIN DANGER

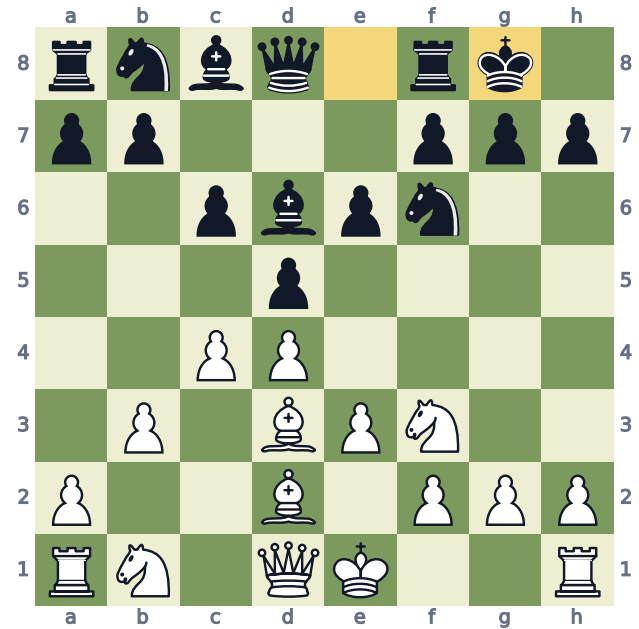
A slow setup can allow ...e5 under ideal conditions.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

b3 prepares Bb2 and recaptures on c4 without queen moves.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.28 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc3 Nbd7 2. O-O Re8 3. Qc2 h6 4. Rad1 e5 5. cxd5 cxd5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Anti-Meran with b3



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Triangle move order



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 e6 3. Nc3 c6 4. Nf3 dxc4 5. a4 Bb4 6. e3 b5 7. Bd2 a5

WHITE'S IDEA

Recognize the Noteboom structure and attack the queenside pawns before they become stable.

MAIN DANGER

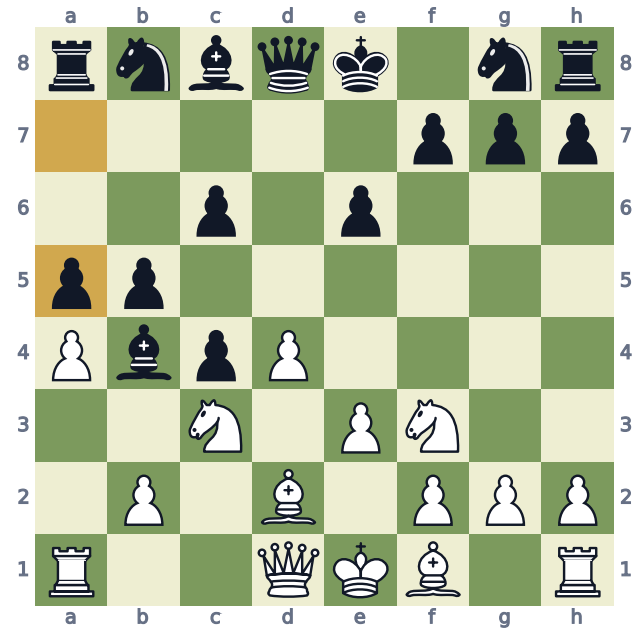
Black's connected passers can become dangerous if White drifts.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

...e6 plus ...c6 before ...Nf6 allows ...dxc4 and ...b5.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.20 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. axb5 Bxc3 2. Bxc3 cxb5 3. b3 Bb7 4. bxc4 b4 5. Bb2 Nf6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Triangle move order



YOUR TASK

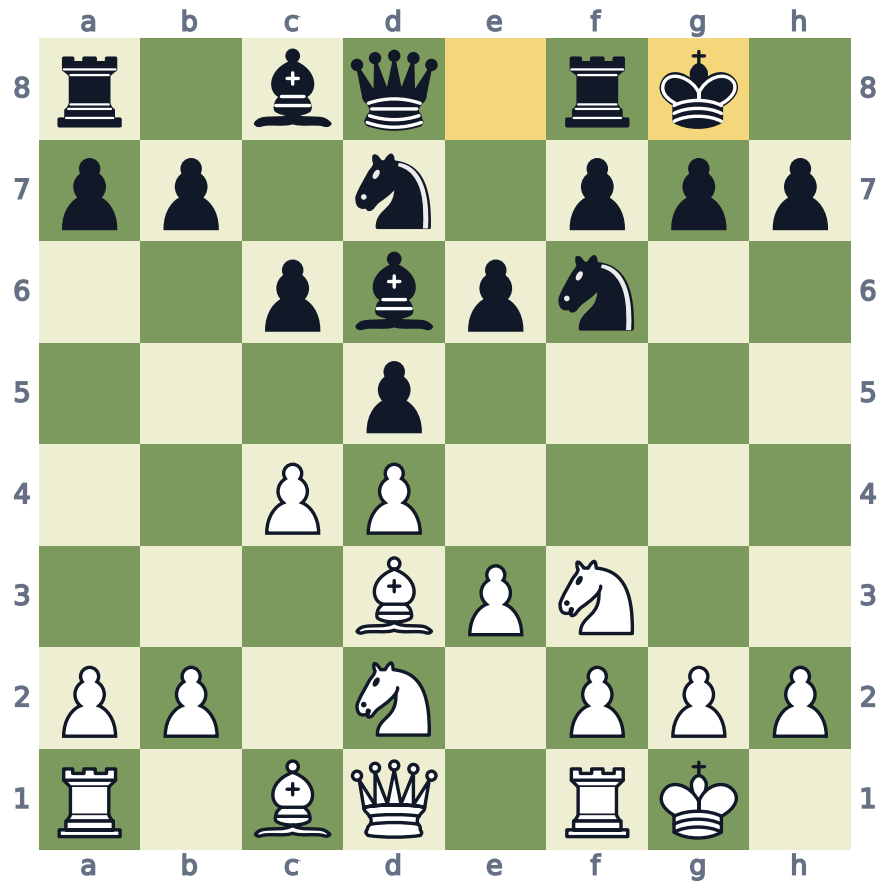
White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Semi-Slav quiet center



COURSE LINE

1. d4 d5 2. c4 c6 3. Nf3 Nf6 4. e3 e6 5. Bd3 Nbd7 6. O-O Bd6 7. Nbd2 O-O

WHITE'S IDEA

Finish development, then choose e4 or a timely central exchange.

MAIN DANGER

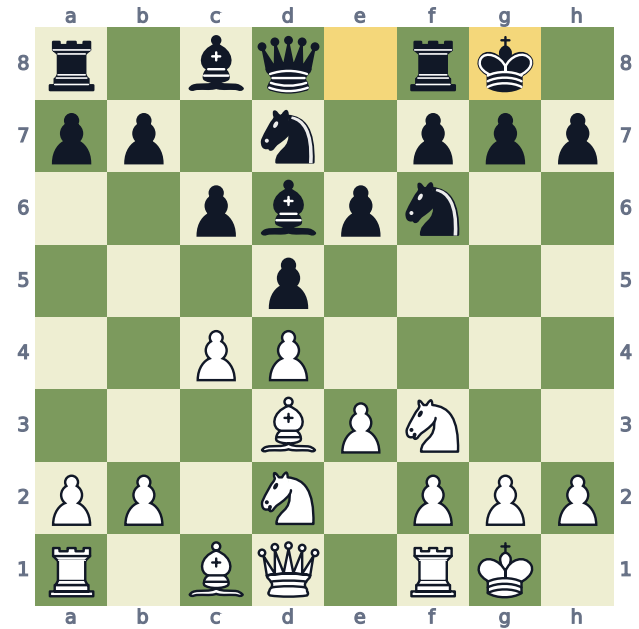
Routine moves can miss Black's ...e5 break.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

In a closed shell, both sides are preparing one freeing pawn break.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.61 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Re1 e5 2. cxd5 cxd5 3. e4 h6 4. h3 dxe4 5. Nxe4 Nxe4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Semi-Slav quiet center



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name Black's opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give Black's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. EXCHANGE SLAV

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Use active piece placement and pressure the c-file in a symmetrical structure.

Engine comparison: 1. Nc3 e6 2. Bf4 Nf6 3. e3 Nc6 4. Bd3 Bd6 5. Bxd6 Qxd6 (+0.44 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Symmetry does not mean a draw; careless development can still concede initiative.

02. MAIN SLAV RECOVERY

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Limit ...b5, recover c4, and castle before central expansion. Engine comparison: 1. e3 e6 2. Bd3 dxc4 3. Bxc4 c5 4. O-O a6 5. dxc5 Bxc5 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: e4 can be met by ...b5 or ...Bb4 if played too early.

03. SLAV ...A6

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Challenge the queenside chain with b3 and complete development. Engine comparison: 1. e3 e6 2. Bd3 dxc4 3. Bxc4 c5 4. O-O a6 5. dxc5 Bxc5 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: An automatic a4 can give Black a protected b4 square.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. SLAV ...G6

Course move: Nc3. Purpose: Develop actively and prepare cxd5 or h3 according to Black's center. Engine comparison: 1. e3 e6 2. Bd3 dxc4 3. Bxc4 c5 4. O-O a6 5. dxc5 Bxc5 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The g7 bishop gains force if White opens d4 carelessly.

05. SEMI-SLAV MERAN

Course move: Bd3. Purpose: Use the central pawn mass before Black completes queenside consolidation. Engine comparison: 1. Qc2 Be7 2. Nc3 O-O 3. b3 dxc4 4. Bxc4 b5 (+0.36 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The center can be undermined by ...cxd4 and ...c5 tactics.

06. ANTI-MERAN WITH B3

Course move: e3. Purpose: Recover c4 with b3 and keep a flexible piece setup. Engine comparison: 1. e3 e6 2. Bd3 dxc4 3. Bxc4 c5 4. O-O a6 5. dxc5 Bxc5 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: A slow setup can allow ...e5 under ideal conditions.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. TRIANGLE MOVE ORDER

Course move: Nf3. Purpose: Recognize the Noteboom structure and attack the queenside pawns before they become stable. Engine comparison: 1. e4 dxe4 2. Nxe4 Bb4+ 3. Bd2 Qxd4 4. Bxb4 Qxe4+ 5. Ne2 Na6 (+0.43 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black's connected passers can become dangerous if White drifts.

08. SEMI-SLAV QUIET CENTER

Course move: e3. Purpose: Finish development, then choose e4 or a timely central exchange. Engine comparison: 1. e3 e6 2. Bd3 dxc4 3. Bxc4 c5 4. O-O a6 5. dxc5 Bxc5 (+0.35 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Routine moves can miss Black's ...e5 break.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.